

The Iconoclast

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Volume I Issue 1

Your Guide to Instant Teaching Certification

Speak professor speak...good dog.

It seems that the educational standards in this country have been waning...it has become a simple matter of: professor regurgitates what he reads from book, students regurgitate teacher's words back. This simple minded spoon-feeding has become the way of the nineties, and students are expected to be prepared for reality when they leave these fine institutions of higher learning called colleges. Rutgers is a relatively widely renowned school for its business and law. It is also reputed to have a wonderful education department that, in essence, has received its reputation for regurgitating the most widely arrayed material anywhere. In the meantime, while students A-Z are learning their ABC's, and are being tested on the relative amount of useless facts they can memorize, the professors putting forth no effort (or as little as possible) are reaping the rewards of their tenured paychecks without threat of being terminated for their lack of learning.

Since the management cannot fire these victims of cranial atrophy, it is my proposal that we place these professors into positions where they can have no impact on a young mind. Somewhere they can read one book and reiterate all that was said in them to passers by and not have too great an impact on those attempting to use their brains.

It is my proposal that an evaluation team be formed to assess the capabilities of all the present professors at Rutgers University in Camden. This team should consist of one graduate student from each of the following departments: psychology-to assess the amount of emotional damage ensuing from a poor education produced by a particular professor, and to assess the amount of positive enforcement of critical thinking that takes place. Mathematics must be among them, to document the amount of time a given professor may have been teaching his or her students in a half-asked way; law-to determine the punitive action and proper placement for inadequate teachers and measure this against the amount of time that they have been so.

This team will then covertly observe a minimum of five classroom sessions with the professor to be evaluated, and will score that professor on the same grading scale, and with the same amount of constructive criticism that his or her students are customarily evaluated on always taking into account classroom size, and course workload. Considering past grading procedures, most professors will be evaluated in the form of a check box format: listing one word adjectives, with the teacher being assessed on a poor, average, good, excellent scale. The professor will then be relocated to a more suitable position in the system according to his or her performance.

I continue my proposal that all professors that rank "poor" be donated to the art department or to the grounds keeping department. They will either be used in post-modernist sculpture, or become lawn ornaments. Should the grounds department be given too many of these professors, it should then be evaluated if they should rather be used as fenceposts, signposts, or perhaps simply be used as fertilizer (This factor is dependant upon their ability to be good signposts or fenceposts, and provided they refuse to resign, and promising that they will never again pursue a teaching profession.). All those professors rated "average" shall be used as change distributors for the snack machines and video games in the student center. Those which are incapable in math will be drafted as napkin dispensers, tray collectors and those who are literate will then be used to change the messages in the message board. All those professors who rate "good" shall be further evaluated to see if they qualify to teach the low level courses in their field. They will be limited to introductory level teaching if they qualify and will have the opportunity once every three years to be re-evaluated for their skills. Those who do not meet this qualification will have to attempt to find work as elementary school teachers (if anyone will have them), or as Wawa employees if they wish to avoid the same fate as the "average" professors. The professors who qualify as "excellent" shall be given a raise. They, too, will be evaluated every three years to determine whether they have slacked and are now only sufficient to be tree stakes.

The reason for this proposal is so that the hoard of money that comes into Rutgers for staff and programs is finally properly spent, and so that the average student at Rutgers Camden may actually learn how to use his or her brain, instead of allowing it to fry (or freeze) in the poorly climate-controlled classrooms. It is further my intention that the professors that continually rape the students of the freedom to speech and opinion (and therefore free-thought) be crumpled up into little compact packages, and cast out of the learning environment, as they are no possitive influence on the learning process.

The good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge." BR.

THE PAPAL DECREE OF THE WEEK

THOU SHALT FEED THE SQUIRRELS ON CAMPUS ONLY DURING THE FALL MONTHS THAT THEY MAY STORE FOOD FOR WINTER. THOU SHALT NOT FEED THE SQUIRRELS CIGARETTE ENDS, NOR UNWANTED PIZZA CRUSTS, NOT THE REMAINS OF HUMAN FLESH. THOU SHALT FEED THE FURRY RODENTS ONLY WITH PEANUTS, PREFERABLY THE KIND THAT ARE UNSHELLED AND NATURALLY ROASTED AVAILABLE IN THE CAMPUS MINI-MART OR MOST WAWAS.

~POPE JOHN

END SIDE ONE

THE BIRTH OF THE PLACEMAN

(or Some People Call Me The Place Cowboy)

Hi,

Well, by now there are those of you who may be asking the question 'What kind of a birth was that?' You expected maybe a gush of fluids and the screams of a being sucking oxygen in its gaseous state for the very first time. Then I say to this portion of my readers (for upon reading these words you are MINE! MUHAHAHA!) provide such special effects for yourselves if you must have them. I make my entrance into your minds unarmed with infomercial frills. I give you unprocessed, 100% pure thoughts. No P. T. Barnum three-ring circus act to sucker you into believing that the sea monkey ideas I parade before your eyes are the one and only truth. I merely ask that you consider what I have to say when I say it (er...WRITE it, that is...). Use the musings and observations I conjure any way you wish. And if, in doing so, something sparks within you or leaves you bored as hell, so be it. Here is what I intend to do. My purpose for existing is to visit a different place now and then and write down whatever the good old spirit of inspiration whaps me over the head with at that place and time. This will hopefully form into a coherent essay of sorts. Corny, huh? TOO BAD! That's the way it works! The subjects I will be feeding down my pen have no boundaries. I take suggestions, bribes, numbers at the deli counter, so on and so forth. Anything for a good story I always say! I will give you the location I am at in some detail, perhaps even going so far as to give directions. Then it will be up to you, intrepid reader, to decide whether or not you will make a sojourn of your own to the place that I have walked. I am not saying that this will make you want to write a story for us or anything suggestive like that...I would never resort to subliminal messages. To go on, I will try to stick to one topic per essay, but I warn you now, they don't call me 'tangent boy' for nothing. Speaking of tangents, any political correctness buffs beware. I no like P.C. You can call me the 'location person' if you like, but please do it behind my back.

One may ask: of all the nicknames out there, why the 'placeman'? I am the proud owner of a severe wander lust. Whatever the reason, whether it be the mad search for inspiration or fleeing the doughnut brandishing law man, I seem to always need to be on the go. From the exotic to the mundane, many types of ground have felt my sole. Now I bear that sole to you my readers! (sniff...sniff, did I change my socks?) My imagination, too, I fear has come to rambling out on some wild romps. What I suppose I am trying to write (er...say...er, dictate) is that I will try to use the travels of my mind and body to bring back an entree for your brain. Often one will discover a dish not palatable. So be it! Take what you like from the coming buffet of ideas. All I ask is that you try something new, if only once in a moon of your colour. Give the taste buds of your mind a surprise. My words are not, by any means, rock chiseled fact. Rather they are the musings of a fellow human. I write in the hope that someone will give me the benefit of the doubt, so that I know what it is like to be one of our species. This is a talent I think we all share. So follow me to places of shadows, light, cold, wood, dark darkness, and a plethora of other firmly rooted adjectives. Maybe once we are there, our imaginations can take us a bit farther. **Since I have a weakness for disclaimer (editor's note: face it he's just weak), here is one: The only meaning for the word stable I know is the place where horses eat sleep, and -you know- so don't be surprised if one moment I am the adjective heavy boy next door, and the next I metamorphose into Nihil, existential king of gothic angst.**

Playtime (by Nikole Nader)

She rose to a mere twelve inches, yet captured all the sophistication possible with her posture permanently erect, a bosome fantastically endowed, a teeny waist and slim hips, with beauty oozing down to her impossibly arched feet. A little girl's dream: the glowing embodiment of it all. Yes, her royal highness, that immortalized icon of Mattel Inc., Barbie.

Like other girls, I spent countless hours by her side, assisting her in catastrophe, whether it be squeezing into the latest glow-in-the-dark tights, or persuading Ken to take her to the soda shoppe in his trans am. She lived the soap opera life in her small suburban Barbie community in a corner of the family room. Naturally, life was flawless. Barbie and friends lived in a spacious 3 story cardboard penthouse equipped with a heart-embossed elevator. The pad was fully furnished with tissue box beds, little spool stools, and an unfushable toilet (Luckily for the Barbies and Ken, bodily excretions never occurred from their plastic frames, besides, the Kens had no way of removing their molded undergarments—consequently they avoided tragic ends.). Fortunately, the community had all the modern comforts, unavailable to their presuccessors, complete with McDonalds, an ice cream shoppe, and a mini-mall carefully constructed from xerox boxes. In between fashion shows and Miss America pageants, Barbie would spend time in her Hawaii getaway, where she would trade her pink and purple unitard for a mo-mo. There, in her cottage, she would sip non-existent tropical drinks, while she relaxed on her hammock and plastic parrots squawked about. Luckily for Barbie, this exotic home-away-from-home was conveniently three inches from her house, so that travel expenses were not an issue. Whenever Barbie became exhausted from her daily schedule of mixing and matching, or brushing her hair, or trying to pry apart her fingers, she would venture into her motorhome which doubled for a fun vehicle to tear down the driveway in. Yet, there were some downfalls to the high life. Minor obstacles arose regularly in playland whenever the Go-bots or Transformers battled out WWII. Most Barbieans had to relocate to Plexi-block crates until the political holocaust ended. Sometimes it took hours.

Indeed, the Valley of the dolls was not always a happy place. Often vicious rumors ran rampant about all the sun-kissed beauties. They were usually started by those jealous Barbie "has-beens" who were tragically maimed with scissors and magic markers, some with fingers practically chewed off.

For the most part, this rubber-headed wonderland was simple. The Barbies loved to bask in their flamboyant tights, and the Kens loved to get their teeth bleached. Then one day, everything changed. Politically Correct Barbie entered their tiny backward community.

PC Barbie was like nothing Barbie or Ken ever saw. To start, her hair was brown and short, and her eyes were brown. Her plastic frame and rubber body was stark white, not attractively sun-kissed. Conveniently enough, she came with an assorted array of washable crayola markers all in earth tones.

PC Barbie was appalled at the fact that most Barbies didn't even own one pair of pants. She also resented the fact that Doctor, Lawyer, Chief, and Anchor woman Barbies did nothing but wear their uniforms. PC Barbie was determined to make something out of the Barbies. She was not about to continue letting local business productivity decline because of a complete lack of employees...

STAY TUNED FOR NEXT WEEK: PART TWO OF PLAYTIME—DISASTER STRIKES....SAME BARBIE TIME, SAME BARBIE CHATEL.

This issue of the Iconoclast brought to you by the number 17 and the letter Q. Send all issue ideas, submissions, complaints, compliments, money, and/or death threats to p00h@clam.rutgers.edu (the two o's are zeroes), or to The Iconoclast c/o P.O. Box 2133, Cinnaminson, NJ 08077 for the computer illiterate.